

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Threat Detection | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations, threat detection, and full-lifecycle incident response. I have expert-level proficiency in Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering workspace design, analytics rule development, data connector configuration, and automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks. I am experienced with CrowdStrike Falcon as a combined Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) platform, and I have working experience with Splunk/SPL for log analysis and investigation. I specialise in developing and tuning detection logic aligned to MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs), conducting proactive threat hunting, and leading incident response as senior escalation point in line with NIST 800-61. I have managed large-scale Microsoft security deployments including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, and Microsoft Entra ID across an 8,000-user estate. I am looking to apply my detection engineering and threat analysis expertise to a senior analyst role where I can drive improvements in threat detection maturity, reduce dwell time, and mentor less experienced analysts.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (workspace design, data connectors, KQL analytics rules, workbooks, incident management); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; Splunk/SPL log analysis and search
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Custom detection rule development, threat hunting queries, investigation workflows, and scheduled analytics in Microsoft Sentinel
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) - expert deployment and threat hunting; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection logic; proactive threat hunting across SIEM, EDR, and cloud environments; detection tuning and false-positive reduction
- **Incident Response:** Senior escalation lead; NIST 800-61-aligned; full incident lifecycle from triage through to post-incident review and lessons learned; playbook authoring and continuous improvement
- **Microsoft Defender Stack:** MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender; 8,000-user enterprise deployment and policy management
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **SOAR Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks; SOAR workflow design and PowerShell scripting for automated response and enrichment
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast email security gateway; Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; least-privilege access and credential governance
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, JISC, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Own the **Microsoft Sentinel** SIEM platform end-to-end: design and maintain the workspace architecture, configure data connectors across cloud and on-premises log sources, develop custom **KQL** analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, and build automated SOAR playbooks for incident enrichment and response.

- Lead **threat hunting** operations using CrowdStrike Falcon and Sentinel KQL queries to proactively identify indicators of compromise, novel attack patterns, and post-compromise activity not yet triggering automated detections.
- Serve as **senior escalation lead** for the security operations function: triage, investigate, and lead response to high-severity incidents in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication, and post-incident review.
- Operate **CrowdStrike Falcon** (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) as primary SME: manage detection policies, tune alert thresholds, develop threat hunting queries, and maintain platform health.
- Manage and improve **detection engineering** across the SIEM and EDR stack: iteratively refine detection rules, reduce false positives, and expand coverage for emerging attacker techniques.
- Administer **Microsoft Defender** (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 users; manage investigation workflows, configure alert policies, and coordinate response actions.
- Use **Splunk** and CrowdStrike for log analysis, search, and correlation during complex threat investigations requiring multi-source data analysis.
- Manage **Microsoft Entra ID**, Conditional Access, and MFA; respond to identity-based threats including credential-based attacks and account compromise events.
- Lead **vulnerability management** using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra BAS; prioritise findings by risk, coordinate remediation, and report status to leadership.
- Develop and maintain incident response playbooks, threat hunting runbooks, and SOC operational documentation.
- Mentor junior security analysts; provide guidance on investigation techniques, tool usage, and MITRE ATT&CK-based analysis.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Performed Tier 2/3 SOC analyst duties across **Microsoft Sentinel** and **CrowdStrike Falcon**: alert triage, investigation, threat detection, and escalation for incidents across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud environments.
- Developed and tuned **KQL** detection rules and correlation queries in Microsoft Sentinel, improving detection coverage and reducing alert fatigue.
- Conducted threat hunting across SIEM and EDR data sources using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hypotheses to proactively identify undetected threats.
- Responded to and investigated security incidents including phishing campaigns, malware execution, account compromise, and insider threat scenarios.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Group Policy, and MFA for a multi-site user estate.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck; tracked remediation progress with asset owners.
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development, automating alert enrichment and initial response actions within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Administered Mimecast email security; supported security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security monitoring, endpoint protection, and access controls across a SaaS/FinTech environment.
- Conducted log analysis and security event investigation to identify and respond to threats across the IT infrastructure.
- Managed identity and access controls, patch management, and vulnerability remediation in line with ISO 27001.
- Supported network security operations and contributed to security documentation, policies, and risk assessments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a full **Microsoft Sentinel** SIEM workspace from greenfield, including 20+ data connectors, custom KQL analytics rules, automated SOAR playbooks, and executive workbooks, significantly improving threat detection maturity.
- Built and operationalised a hybrid **SOC** capability combining CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection and response across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Deployed **Microsoft Defender** (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across an 8,000-user estate, expanding threat detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces.
- Delivered measurable reduction in **mean time to detect (MTTD)** and **mean time to respond (MTTR)** through detection engineering improvements and SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Authored a comprehensive library of **incident response playbooks** and threat hunting runbooks, establishing consistent and repeatable SOC processes.
- Maintained **Cyber Essentials Plus** accreditation; led technical control validation across patching, access control, malware protection, and firewall domains.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000–85,000 | Hybrid (UK)